



FUTURE OF EVS IN INDIA

A pragmatic look toward the adoption of electric vehicles

Yetnesh Dubey | feedback@digit.in

Electric Vehicles - The only thing that comes to our mind after listening to this word is an endless barrage of auto and industry experts highlighting dates far in the future when all of us will drive these silent machines during the day and charge them with long-running cables outside our apartment windows at night. At least, that's how we imagine the charging infrastructure would work out.

But what is the true future of EVs? More specifically, what's the future of EVs in India. A country with a population of over a billion vastly different people. In our opinion, EVs will find their place in the Indian market but not in the usual sense.

We're thinking in a black and white manner about a problem that exists in various shades of grey.

And if we are keen on peeking into the future today, then taking a look at the US auto market can offer

a glimpse of what's to come. It would seem that we love the American culture, we consume their entertainment, play their video games, and even mimic their holidays.

A very interesting AAA survey of electric vehicle owners from January 2020 gives us some pretty revealing insights. The survey highlighted that around 78 per cent of EV owners had a second vehicle at home. So if anyone of us were worried that our petrol car wouldn't see the light of day, then it's a misconception. However, the same owners did most of their driving, around 87 per cent, with their EVs. And it makes perfect sense.

Our cars drive mostly to and from our offices. For a majority of people, driving daily to the office is not fun. If you're driving a lowered 2020 Suzuki IGNIS with low profile tires and a stage 1 engine remap then it can make the morning commute fun, but for most hard-working wage earners, it is a task. Not too dissimilar to washing clothes or doing the dishes. It is a chore and it needs an appliance i.e. an electric vehicle. And upon a closer look, it is pretty clear why an EV is more suited for this task.

EVs deliver a higher battery range in stop-and-go traffic. A user can sit in an EV with the AC running without additionally running its electric motor. In an IC car we have to turn ON the engine before starting the AC. With regenerative braking, EVs become even more efficient as the energy that would have been wasted while braking in a car, now essentially refills the battery instead.

